PassFrame
TUITION

The Night Train

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

The night train rattles down the track,
clickety-clack, clickety-clack,
past sleeping towns and fields of wheat,
a rhythm steady as a heartbeat.

I press my face against the glass
and watch the dark world slowly pass:
a farmhouse light, a distant spire,
a lonely chimney's curling fire.

The carriage hums a gentle song,
the journey far, the night is long,
and other travellers, half-asleep,
let silence settle soft and deep.

I wonder where the others go,
what stories ride this train, below
the rattling wheels, the swaying light —
a thousand journeys, one shared night.

At last my eyelids start to close,
the clickety-clack becomes a doze,
and somewhere past the edge of sleep,
the night train rattles on, and keeps.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. What sound does the train make, according to the first verse?

2. Name two things the poet sees out of the window.

3. Underline the line that tells you the carriage was quiet.

4. Underline the simile that compares the train's rhythm to something else.

5. What does “curling” suggest about the smoke from the distant chimney?

6. True or false: all the other travellers on the train are wide awake.

7. Why do you think the poet wonders “where the others go” and “what stories ride this train”?

8. What happens to the poet by the end of the poem?

9. In your own words, describe the mood or atmosphere of this poem.

10. What does the phrase “a thousand journeys, one shared night” suggest about the other passengers?

11. Why do you think the poet repeats the sound “clickety-clack” throughout the poem?

12. Do you think this poem feels peaceful or unsettling? Explain your answer using evidence from the text.